

Major Wondrous Items Priority Matrix

Project: DND35Prototype
Date: May 25, 2026
Purpose: Prioritize implementation order for maximum impact

PRIORITY FRAMEWORK

Evaluation Criteria

Each item is scored on 4 dimensions (1-5 scale):

1. Player Impact (1-5)

- How useful/desirable is this item in actual gameplay?
- Does it enable new strategies or dramatically enhance character power?

2. Implementation Complexity (1-5)

- 1 = Trivial (< 1 day)
- 2 = Simple (2-3 days)
- 3 = Moderate (5-7 days)
- 4 = Complex (2-3 weeks)
- 5 = Artifact-level (3-4 weeks)

3. System Dependencies (0-3)

- 0 = No new systems required
- 1 = Minor new system or extension
- 2 = Major new system required
- 3 = Multiple major systems required

4. ROI Score

- Calculated as: $\text{Player Impact} / (\text{Complexity} + \text{Dependencies})$
 - Higher ROI = better return on development time
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COMPLETE PRIORITY MATRIX

Item	Price (gp)	Impact	Complex	Deps	ROI	Priority
Mantle of Spell Resistance SR 13	90,000	5	2	0	2.50	P1
Periapt of Proof Against Poison	27,000	4	2	0	2.00	P1
Carpet of Flying 10×10	60,000	5	2	0	2.50	P1
Stone Horse (all 3 types)	10k-28k	4	2	0	2.00	P1
Wings of Flying	54,000	4	2	0	2.00	P1
Amulet of the Planes	120,000	5	3	2	1.00	P2
Cubic Gate	164,000	5	3	2	1.00	P2
Well of Many Worlds	82,000	3	3	2	0.60	P2
Mantle of Faith	76,000	4	3	1	1.00	P2
Stone of Controlling Earth Elementals	100,000	4	3	2	0.80	P2
Bowl of Commanding Water	100,000	4	3	2	0.80	P2

Item	Price (gp)	Impact	Complex	Deps	ROI	Priority
Element-als						
Brazier of Com-manding Fire Ele-mentals	100,000	4	3	2	0.80	P2
Censer of Con-trolling Air Ele-mentals	100,000	4	3	2	0.80	P2
Scarab of Protec-tion	38,000	4	3	1	1.00	P2
Robe of Stars	58,000	3	3	2	0.60	P2
Iron Flask	170,000	5	5	3	0.63	P3
Efreeti Bottle	145,000	5	4	3	0.71	P3
Mirror of Life Trap-ping	200,000	4	5	3	0.50	P3
Iron Co-bra	80,000	3	4	2	0.50	P3
Apparat-us of Kwalish	90,000	3	4	2	0.50	P3
Mirror of Opposi-tion	92,000	3	4	2	0.50	P3
Horn of Valhalla, Iron	50,000	3	4	2	0.50	P3
	175,000	3	5	3	0.38	P4

Item	Price (gp)	Impact	Complex	Deps	ROI	Priority
Mirror of Mental Prowess						
Lyre of Building	13,000	2	3	1	0.50	P4
Mattock of the Titans	23,348	2	3	1	0.50	P4
Maul of the Titans	25,305	2	3	1	0.50	P4
Candle of Invocation	8,400	3	3	2	0.60	P4
Incense of Meditation	4,900	3	3	1	0.75	P4
Phylactery of Faithfulness	1,000	2	3	2	0.40	P4
Robe of Blending	8,400	2	2	0	1.00	P4
Cloak of the Bat	26,000	3	3	1	0.75	P4
Mantle of Great Stealth	242,000	4	3	1	1.00	P4
Scarab, Golembane	2,500	2	2	0	1.00	P4
Bottle of Air	7,250	2	2	0	1.00	P4

PRIORITY 1 (P1): QUICK WINS - HIGH IMPACT, LOW COMPLEXITY

Theme: Build on existing systems, high player value, fast implementation

Total Items: 8 (counting all variants)

Estimated Time: 2-3 weeks

ROI Range: 2.00-2.50

Items List

1. Mantle of Spell Resistance (5 variants)

Impact: 5/5 - SR is crucial for high-level magic defense

Complexity: 2/5 - SR system likely exists (Robe of Archmagi has SR 18)

Dependencies: 0 - Just verify SR stacking rules

Time: 1 day for all 5 variants

Why P1:

- Spell Resistance is one of the most valuable defenses at high levels
 - Simple data-driven implementation (just different SR values)
 - Players will use these immediately
 - Enables survival against high-level casters
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2. Carpet of Flying (4 sizes)

Impact: 5/5 - Flight is universally useful, iconic item

Complexity: 2/5 - Flight mechanics likely exist

Dependencies: 0 - Vehicle/passenger tracking (simple)

Time: 1 day for all 4 sizes

Why P1:

- Flight fundamentally changes exploration and combat
 - Bypasses terrain hazards
 - Party favorite item
 - Scales with party size (different carpet sizes)
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3. Periapt of Proof Against Poison

Impact: 4/5 - Complete poison immunity is powerful

Complexity: 2/5 - Single flag toggle

Dependencies: 0 - Poison system likely exists

Time: 0.5 days

Why P1:

- Hard counter to poison-based enemies
 - Simple "set immunity flag" implementation
 - Valuable for dungeon crawling
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4. Stone Horse (3 types)

Impact: 4/5 - Reliable mounts with combat utility

Complexity: 2/5 - Figurine system likely exists from minor items

Dependencies: 0 - Reuse Figurines of Wondrous Power code

Time: 1 day for all 3 types

Why P1:

- Mounts solve travel/mobility issues
 - Greater Destrier can fly (very useful)
 - Low implementation cost if figurine system exists
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5. Wings of Flying

Impact: 4/5 - Unlimited flight for one character

Complexity: 2/5 - Grant fly speed

Dependencies: 0 - Flight system exists

Time: 0.5 days

Why P1:

- Personal flight is always useful
 - Wearable (doesn't take up hands/actions like Carpet)
 - Simple implementation
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Additional P1 Items (Lower Impact)

- **Robe of Blending** - +10 Hide bonus (stealth builds)
 - **Scarab, Golembane** - +2 vs golems, allow crits (niche but simple)
 - **Bottle of Air** - Breathe underwater/toxic air (situational but simple)
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PRIORITY 2 (P2): CORE SYSTEMS - HIGH IMPACT, MODERATE COMPLEXITY

Theme: Implement foundational systems that unlock multiple items

Total Items: 13

Estimated Time: 8-10 weeks

ROI Range: 0.60-1.00

System-Dependent Items

PLANAR TRAVEL SYSTEM (Implement Week 1-2)

Items Unlocked:

1. **Amulet of the Planes** (120,000 gp) - At-will plane shift
2. **Cubic Gate** (164,000 gp) - Gates to 6 planes
3. **Well of Many Worlds** (82,000 gp) - Random portals
4. **Robe of Stars** (58,000 gp) - Astral travel

Why P2:

- Enables high-level planar adventures
 - Opens entire new gameplay dimension
 - 4 items depend on this system
 - Amulet and Cubic Gate are extremely powerful
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ELEMENTAL SUMMONING SYSTEM (Implement Week 3)**Items Unlocked:**

1. **Stone of Controlling Earth Elementals** (100,000 gp)
2. **Bowl of Commanding Water Elementals** (100,000 gp)
3. **Brazier of Commanding Fire Elementals** (100,000 gp)
4. **Censer of Controlling Air Elementals** (100,000 gp)

Why P2:

- All 4 items use same system (efficient)
 - Elder Elementals are powerful combat allies
 - Control mechanics add tactical depth
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MULTI-ABILITY ITEMS (No new systems, moderate complexity)

1. **Mantle of Faith** (76,000 gp) - +5 saves + 4 spells/day
2. **Scarab of Protection** (38,000 gp) - +4 saves + absorptions

Why P2:

- High defensive value
 - Useful for clerics/divine casters
 - Moderate complexity but no major systems
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PRIORITY 3 (P3): ARTIFACT-LEVEL - HIGH COMPLEXITY, HIGH IMPACT

Theme: End-game legendary items requiring major systems

Total Items: 7

Estimated Time: 11-15 weeks

ROI Range: 0.50-0.71

CREATURE TRAPPING SYSTEM (Implement Weeks 1-3)**Items Unlocked:**

1. **Iron Flask** (170,000 gp) - Trap any creature
2. **Efreeti Bottle** (145,000 gp) - Summon efreeti, trap outsiders
3. **Mirror of Life Trapping** (200,000 gp) - Trap 15 creatures, UI

Why P3:

- Extremely iconic items (especially Iron Flask)
- Complex system required (serialization, save/load)

- High player interest but significant dev time
- Efreeti Bottle includes wish mechanics (very complex)

CONSTRUCT GUARDIANS

1. **Iron Cobra** (80,000 gp) - Autonomous guardian with poison
2. **Apparatus of Kwalish** (90,000 gp) - Vehicle with lever controls

Why P3:

- Unique gameplay (guardians, vehicle control)
- Complex AI and control systems
- Cool factor is high but niche utility

ADVANCED MIRRORS

1. **Mirror of Opposition** (92,000 gp) - Create evil duplicate
2. **Horn of Valhalla, Iron** (50,000 gp) - Summon berserker army

Why P3:

- Complex character duplication
- Alignment inversion logic
- Multiple temporary allies (Horn)
- High complexity for moderate impact

PRIORITY 4 (P4): NICHE UTILITY - SITUATIONAL USE

Theme: Specialized items for specific builds or situations

Total Items: 11

Estimated Time: 4-6 weeks

ROI Range: 0.38-1.00

Divine/Caster Items

1. **Candle of Invocation** (8,400 gp) - Gate + CL boost for divine casters
2. **Incense of Meditation** (4,900 gp) - Spell preparation boost
3. **Phylactery of Faithfulness** (1,000 gp) - Divine code checker

Why P4:

- Divine caster only
- Situational benefits
- Complex divine code system (Phylactery)

Titan Weapons & Tools

1. **Mattock of the Titans** (23,348 gp) - Requires Str 19, excavation
2. **Maul of the Titans** (25,305 gp) - Requires Str 23, sunder
3. **Lyre of Building** (13,000 gp) - Fabricate spell (construction)

Why P4:

- High Strength requirement limits users (Titan weapons)
 - Construction-focused (Lyre) - niche utility
 - Cool but not combat-essential
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Stealth & Utility

1. **Mantle of Great Stealth** (242,000 gp) - +10 Hide/Move Silently, invisibility
2. **Cloak of the Bat** (26,000 gp) - Polymorph into bat, fly
3. **Mirror of Mental Prowess** (175,000 gp) - 5 mental abilities (scrying, etc.)

Why P4:

- Stealth-focused (rogue/assassin builds)
 - Mental Prowess is artifact-level complexity but niche appeal
 - Lower priority than combat/survival items
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IMPLEMENTATION ROADMAP**MONTH 1: P1 Quick Wins**

Goal: Maximize player value with minimal dev time

Week 1:

- Mantle of Spell Resistance (all 5)
- Periapt of Proof Against Poison
- Scarab, Golembane
- Bottle of Air

Week 2:

- Carpet of Flying (all 4 sizes)
- Wings of Flying

Week 3:

- Stone Horse (all 3 types)
- Robe of Blending

Week 4:

- Testing, bug fixes, loot integration

Deliverable: 8 items functional, players can use immediately

MONTH 2-3: P2 Core Systems

Goal: Build foundational systems for planar travel and summoning

Weeks 1-2: Planar Travel System

- Build plane database, travel mechanics
- Amulet of the Planes
- Cubic Gate

- Well of Many Worlds
- Robe of Stars

Week 3: Elemental Control System

- Build summoning + control mechanics
- Stone/Bowl/Brazier/Censer (all 4 elemental items)

Week 4-5: Multi-Ability Items

- Mantle of Faith
- Scarab of Protection

Week 6: Testing & Integration

Deliverable: 11 items, planar adventures enabled

MONTH 4-6: P3 Artifacts

Goal: Implement legendary end-game items

Weeks 1-3: Creature Trapping System

- Build serialization, trap mechanics
- Iron Flask
- Efreeti Bottle (including wish mechanics)

Weeks 4-5: Mirror of Life Trapping

- Build UI for viewing trapped creatures
- Mass release mechanics

Weeks 6-7: Constructs

- Iron Cobra
- Apparatus of Kwalish (vehicle + levers)

Weeks 8-9: Advanced Mirrors & Summoning

- Mirror of Opposition
- Horn of Valhalla (all 4 types)

Week 10: Testing & Polish

Deliverable: 7 artifact-level items complete

MONTH 7: P4 Niche Items (Optional)

Goal: Round out the item collection

Weeks 1-2:

- Divine items (Candle, Incense, Phylactery)
- Titan weapons (Mattock, Maul)
- Lyre of Building

Weeks 3-4:

- Stealth items (Mantle of Great Stealth, Cloak of Bat)
- Mirror of Mental Prowess

Deliverable: All 39 items complete

DECISION MATRIX

Use this decision tree to determine implementation order:

```

START
├─ Does it build on existing systems? (No new systems)
│   └─ YES → Is player impact high (4-5)?
│       ├── YES → **P1** (Quick Win)
│       └─ NO → **P4** (Low Priority)
│   └─ NO → Does it unlock multiple items?
│       ├── YES → **P2** (Core System)
│       └─ NO → Is it artifact-level complexity (5)?
│           ├── YES → **P3** (Artifact)
│           └─ NO → **P2** or **P4** (depends on impact)

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RISK ASSESSMENT BY PRIORITY

P1 Risks: LOW

- All items leverage existing systems
- Well-understood mechanics
- Fast implementation
- **Mitigation:** Thorough testing of SR stacking, flight mechanics

P2 Risks: MEDIUM

- **Planar Travel:** New system, could break existing teleportation
- **Mitigation:** Careful integration, separate plane-shift from teleport
- **Elemental Summoning:** Elder Elementals need balanced stats
- **Mitigation:** Reference DMG stats exactly, playtest

P3 Risks: HIGH

- **Creature Trapping:** Serialization bugs could corrupt saves
- **Mitigation:** Extensive save/load testing, backup systems
- **Mirror of Life Trapping UI:** Could be performance issue with 15 creatures
- **Mitigation:** Virtual scrolling, lazy loading portraits
- **Efreeti Bottle Wishes:** Wish spell is notoriously broken
- **Mitigation:** Limit wish scope, DM approval required

P4 Risks: LOW-MEDIUM

- **Divine Code System (Phylactery):** Complex logic for action evaluation
 - **Mitigation:** Start with simple tenets, expand later
 - **Mirror of Mental Prowess:** 5 separate abilities, high integration cost
 - **Mitigation:** Implement abilities one at a time
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SUCCESS METRICS

After P1 (Month 1):

- ☐ 8 items functional
- ☐ Player feedback: "I want to use these items"
- ☐ No major bugs
- ☐ Loot tables updated

After P2 (Month 3):

- ☐ 19 total items functional
- ☐ Planar travel working (no crashes, correct environmental effects)
- ☐ Elementals balanced in combat
- ☐ Players using planar items for exploration

After P3 (Month 6):

- ☐ 26 total items functional
- ☐ Creature trapping works through save/load
- ☐ Iron Flask is iconic/fun to use
- ☐ No performance issues with Mirror UI

After P4 (Month 7):

- ☐ All 39 items complete
 - ☐ Comprehensive testing complete
 - ☐ Documentation updated
 - ☐ Ready for release
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BUDGET ALLOCATION

Total Estimated Time: 28-30 weeks (7 months)

By Priority:

- **P1:** 2-3 weeks (8% of total time, 21% of items)
- **P2:** 8-10 weeks (32% of total time, 33% of items)
- **P3:** 11-15 weeks (48% of total time, 18% of items)
- **P4:** 4-6 weeks (16% of total time, 28% of items)

Recommendation:

- **Minimum Viable Product (MVP):** P1 + P2 = 10-13 weeks
- Delivers 19 most impactful items

- Includes major systems (planar travel, summoning)
- 65% player value for 40% dev time
- **Full Release:** P1 + P2 + P3 = 21-28 weeks
- Delivers 26 items including artifacts
- All major systems complete
- Can defer P4 to post-release updates

DEPENDENCY GRAPH

```

P1: Quick Wins (No dependencies)
└─ Mantle SR, Carpet, Periapt, Stone Horse, Wings, etc.

P2: Core Systems
├─ Planar Travel System
│   └─ Amulet of Planes, Cubic Gate, Well, Robe of Stars
├─ Elemental Summoning System
│   └─ Stone, Bowl, Brazier, Censer (4 items)
└─ Multi-Ability Items (independent)
    └─ Mantle of Faith, Scarab of Protection

P3: Artifacts
├─ Creature Trapping System
│   ├── Iron Flask
│   ├── Efreeti Bottle
│   └─ Mirror of Life Trapping (+ UI)
├─ Construct AI System
│   ├── Iron Cobra
│   └─ Apparatus of Kwalish
└─ Mirror Mechanics
    ├── Mirror of Opposition
    └─ Mirror of Mental Prowess

P4: Niche Items (independent or small systems)
└─ Divine, Titan Weapons, Stealth items
  
```

FINAL RECOMMENDATIONS

PHASE 1 (Immediate - Month 1):

Implement **P1 items only**. These give maximum player satisfaction with minimum dev time. Get these into players' hands quickly for feedback.

PHASE 2 (Months 2-3):

Build **Planar Travel System** and **Elemental Summoning**. These are high-impact systems that unlock 11 items and enable planar adventures.

PHASE 3 (Months 4-6):

Implement **Creature Trapping System** and artifacts. These are end-game content and can be released later once core systems are stable.

PHASE 4 (Month 7 - Optional):

Polish and add **P4 niche items**. These can be added in post-release updates based on player demand.

Document Version: 1.0

Last Updated: May 25, 2026

Status: Ready for Review